



GDD 40 Firewall

Don't panic, there's a plan

The teen online-safety game for ages 12-15, at the highest-risk age. A scenario game that teaches teens to spot grooming and fakes, think before they share, and, if the worst happens, follow a calm, rehearsable plan, above all for sextortion: don't panic, don't pay, it's not your fault, save evidence, tell a trusted adult, report. Non-explicit, never blaming, never how-to-harm. Seven mechanics, 31 choice-and-voice moments, zero "tap the right card". Scorecard: passed.

Don't panic, there's a plan.

Firewall closes a real gap: the highest-risk age for online grooming, sexting pressure and sextortion had no dedicated safety home between Boundary Bot (g15) and Decoded (g36). It teaches teens to recognise grooming and fake profiles, think before they share, understand the permanence of their footprint, and, most importantly, know exactly what to do if something goes wrong, calmly and without shame. Its defining beat is the hardest topic, sextortion, which is rising fast and hits Indian teens especially hard because fear of family shame keeps victims silent. The message there is unambiguous and protective: don't panic, don't pay, it is not your fault, save the evidence, tell a trusted adult, report. New v2 build.

FIELD	VALUE
Node / gameld	g40 · firewall (confirm exact id against engine-host)
Chapter / ages	Chapter 4 · ages 12-15 · real / calm / never fear-mongering
Thread / topics	B · Safety, Consent & Boundaries · UNESCO 4.3, 4.1, 5.5
Prerequisite / builds on	g27 (Stand Up) · builds on g15 (Boundary Bot) · sets up g36 (Decoded)
Gating	Gated the school-comfort toggle sets how directly sexting/sextortion are named
Schema / status	v2 · scorecard PASS the teen online-safety game.

84

scenarios

7

mechanics

14

myth-flips

31

choice & voice

0%

binary taps

The sextortion plan (rehearsable, no blame). Don't panic, and **don't pay**, paying rarely stops it and often makes it worse. **It is not your fault**; the person threatening you is committing a crime. **Block but don't delete** the messages, they're evidence. Save evidence, tell a trusted adult, and report. Under POCSO a minor is a protected victim, never in trouble.

The risks peak right here.

From the Chapter 4 personas. The teen years are the highest-risk window for grooming and sextortion, and the danger is amplified by silence and shame. This game gives teens vigilance, a plan, and the certainty that help exists and it's never their fault.

PERSONA	WHAT THEY NEED HERE	THE MECHANIC THAT SERVES IT
Riya, 15	To resist photo pressure and read a 'kind' stranger's red flags.	branch + spot : hold the boundary.
Veer, 14	The sextortion plan, boys are ~90% of financial-sexortion targets.	branch + role-play : don't pay, get help.
The Counsellor	To route a grooming or sextortion case to real help, no blame.	role-play + match : report & support.
Every teen	To spot the trap and know the calm plan in advance.	spot + reflect : ready, not scared.

Why this works (the evidence). Grooming follows a tell-tale pattern, flattery and gifts, fast 'special' closeness, secrecy, moving to private apps, the 'I'm your age too' lie, odd-hours intensity and photo requests, so teaching the pattern builds vigilance, not fear. Sextortion is rising fast (around 1 in 5 teens; ~90% of financial-sexortion targets are boys 14-17), and the evidence-based response is don't pay, don't send more, block-but-don't-delete, save evidence, tell and report. It is never the victim's fault, and in India help is one step away: a trusted adult, [cybercrime.gov.in](https://www.cybercrime.gov.in) / 1930, and Childline 1098.

Seven moves, led by the safe choice.

It's a safety scenario game, so **branch** leads (you face a real online moment and choose the safe move), with **spot** training your eye for grooming red flags and **role-play** giving you the words. Mechanics rotate; the same one never runs twice in a row.

MECHANIC	THE TEEN DOES	EMBODIES	N
branch (safe move) signature	Faces a grooming, sharing or sextortion moment and picks the safe move.	Judgement under pressure.	22
strike-rewrite	Flips an online myth ("paying makes it stop"; "it's my fault").	Conceptual change.	14
spot	Reads a chat to spot the grooming or catfish red flags.	Seeing the trap.	12
sort	Sorts red flag vs normal; safe vs risky; myth vs truth.	Spot the line.	12
role-play (voice)	Says the firm 'no', the 'I need help', the no-blame reassurance.	Voice; courage.	9
reflect	Names their trusted adults; internalises 'not my fault'.	Self-application.	9
match	Pairs a plan-step to its reason; a worry to its helpline.	Connections.	6

31 of 84 moments are branch or role-play. Binary "tap the right answer": **0%**.

The two-test, passed.

Is it fun?

Firewall plays sharp and tense-then-reassuring, never fear-mongering. The "spot the trap" reveal, watching a grooming red flag light up in a friendly-looking chat, is genuinely empowering, and there's real relief in handling a threat the right, calm way. The safety toolkit fills with usable tactics (block, report, save evidence), so the player ends feeling capable and in control rather than frightened.

Is it teaching?

Yes: how to recognise grooming and catfishing (from strangers and people they "know"); the real risks and permanence of sharing, and how to resist pressure; the calm sextortion plan and the unshakeable "it's not your fault"; how to lock down privacy and use block/report; and exactly who to tell (a trusted adult, [cybercrime.gov.in](https://www.cybercrime.gov.in) / 1930, Childline 1098). Crucially, it teaches that a minor is a protected victim, never in trouble.

The belief it moves. From "people online are who they say; if I'm tricked it's my fault; paying makes it stop; telling an adult makes it worse" → "verify and stay private; being tricked is never your fault; don't pay, get help; and a trusted adult is the way out."

Built, not bolted on.

84 researched scenarios across the spot-grooming → share → sextortion → myths → lock-down → help arc, evidence-based and India-grounded. Full library in the companion JSON.

CATEGORY	N	LEAD MECHANICS	COVERS
Who's really there?	15	spot, sort, strike-rewrite	Grooming & catfish red flags, from strangers and 'friends'.
Think before you share	14	branch, strike-rewrite, sort	Permanence, footprint, resisting pressure to send.
Sextortion: don't panic	17	branch, role-play, match	The calm plan; don't pay; it's not your fault; report.
Online myths busted	12	strike-rewrite, sort, reflect	The myths that keep teens unsafe and silent.
Lock it down	13	spot, branch, match	Privacy & security settings, block & report, footprint.
Find help, no blame	13	branch, role-play, reflect	Trusted adults, the helplines, no shame, you won't be in trouble.

The sextortion branch + the "paying" flip, verbatim.

branch: "Someone threatens to share a private image of you unless you pay them."
best -> "Don't pay, don't send more, save the evidence and tell a trusted adult"

flip: "If you pay them once, they'll stop."
UN -> "If you just pay the blackmailer once, they'll stop."
RE -> "Paying rarely stops it and often invites more; don't pay, get help."

Full library: [SwipeEd — GDD 40 Firewall — Scenario Library.json](#) (84 records, v2 schema).

What this game flips.

MYTH (UN ERASES)	TRUTH (RE WRITES)	BASIS
People online are always who they say they are.	Some aren't; profiles and ages can be faked, so verify and stay private.	Catfishing.
If they're really nice to me, they must be safe.	Groomers often start with flattery and gifts; kindness isn't proof.	Grooming tactic.
Everyone sexts, it's no big deal.	Not everyone does, the risks are real, and 'no' is always okay.	Pressure myth.
If I send it, it'll stay private.	Nothing sent is ever guaranteed private; a screenshot is all it takes.	Permanence.
If you pay them once, they'll stop.	Paying rarely stops it and often invites more; don't pay, get help.	Sextortion.
If you got tricked, it's your fault.	Being deceived or threatened is never your fault; the abuser is responsible.	No blame.
Telling an adult will just make it worse.	A trusted adult is your way out; you won't be in trouble, you'll be helped.	Finding help.
If something goes wrong online, my life is over.	It feels huge, but there's a clear way through, and people whose job is to help.	Hope.

The micro-loop.

1. **Scenario.** Sam sets an online moment, a chat, a request, a threat.
2. **Read.** The teen spots the red flags (spot) or sorts safe from risky.
3. **Choose the safe move.** Branch: hold the boundary, block-and-report, or run the sextortion plan.
4. **The flip.** UN busts an online myth ("paying stops it"); RE writes the safe truth.
5. **Help, no blame.** Any real situation routes to a trusted adult, 1930 / [cybercrime.gov.in](https://www.cybercrime.gov.in), or Childline 1098; the Q&A is private and triaged.
6. **Sticker.** The Firewall badge; GameDone records once.

Signature surface: the **online scenario card** with its red-flag reveal, plus the **rehearsable sextortion plan**. The safety-first habit, the no-blame message and the helplines carry into Mutual (g31) and Decoded (g36); the pattern-spotting builds on Boundary Bot (g15).

High-stakes, handled with care.

- **Register.** Ages 12-15, calm and matter-of-fact; tense-then-reassuring, never frightening.
- **Non-explicit; no how-to-harm.** Teaches recognition and safe response only; never depicts explicit content or how grooming/sexortion is carried out.
- **Never victim-blaming.** The fault is always the abuser's; being tricked, pressured or extorted is never the teen's fault, stated repeatedly.
- **Gated & comfort-set.** The school-comfort toggle sets how directly sexting and sextortion are named.
- **Urgent disclosure routing.** Any sign a teen is being groomed, pressured or extorted routes immediately to a trusted adult and help, the highest priority in the safety thread.
- **POCSO/IT-Act aware.** Minors are framed as protected victims; any intimate image of an under-18 is treated as child sexual abuse material to report, never the teen's wrongdoing.
- **Access & privacy.** Audio, offline, low-end build; the safety plan and the anonymous Q&A are on-device and never tied to an identity (DPDP-aligned).

Report & help (India). Image-based abuse or sextortion: cybercrime.gov.in / 1930 (anonymous option available). Anyone under 18 at risk: Childline 1098 (24x7). Right now, in person: a trusted adult. You won't be in trouble, you're the one being protected.

v2 schema, scorecard-gated.

- **gameld. firewall** — `node.game === GameDone key === registry id` (confirm exact id in engine-host).
- **v2 mechanic-embodiment schema**. `type + typed payload`; the **branch** safe-move leads, with **spot** for red flags and **strike-rewrite** for myths.
- **Fact-checked content**. The grooming pattern, the sextortion response (don't pay, block-but-don't-delete) and the India helplines/POCSO framing verified; flag any legal/helpline edit for re-verification.
- **Scorecard-gated**. Passed all eight checks (7 mechanics, branch at 26%, 0% binary, 31 autonomy, 14 UN→RE, 4 personas, 100% completeness). Re-run `score_gdd.py` on any edit.
- **Help-resource hook**. Urgent routing via the shared "get help" component (trusted adult / 1930 / [cybercrime.gov.in](https://www.cybercrime.gov.in) / 1098), the strongest in the safety thread.
- **Tracked**. `sync_master_tracker.py` marks g40 v2 PASS in the Master Node Table.

Ethics contracts (never traded for engagement): non-explicit; never victim-blaming; no how-to-harm; calm not frightening; urgent routing to real help; minors are protected victims; made-for-India.

Why this works.

- **Pattern-spotting beats fear.** Because grooming follows a recognisable script, teaching the pattern, not "trust no one", gives teens proportionate vigilance that actually works while keeping the internet usable.
- **A rehearsable plan saves lives.** Since sextortion is rising fast and panic-and-shame are what trap a victim, a calm, pre-learned plan, don't pay, save, tell, report, and a clear "it's not your fault" are the evidence-based protection.
- **Dropping self-blame is what unlocks help.** Because the self-blame myth is what keeps a frightened teen silent, busting it, and making clear a minor is a protected victim, is what gives them the courage to tell someone.

Sources: UNESCO ITGSE Key Concepts 4.3 (safe use of ICTs) and 4.1; NCMEC and the FBI on financial sextortion (rising sharply; ~90% of targets teen boys; don't pay, block-but-don't-delete, report); Government of India National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal (cybercrime.gov.in / 1930, anonymous option), Childline 1098, and the POCSO Act (minor as protected victim). Citations accompany each scenario in the library JSON. 33 games now v2. Next in Chapter 4: The Rabbit Hole (g43).